

Text for the RAG database

Blog1

Achieving financial freedom as a Nigerian can feel like an uphill climb, but learning how to maximise your financial resources might just be the secret sauce. In economically uncertain times like these, taking control of your finances can help alleviate stress and improve the quality of your life.

This guide will explain disposable income and how to calculate it. We'll also share smart budgeting, spending, and saving tips for Nigerians and how this knowledge can significantly improve your financial health.

What is disposable income?

Disposable income is the money you have left after paying your taxes and other mandatory financial obligations.

As a salary earner, your disposable income — also called net income — is your “take-home pay” or “spendable income.” This is the amount left over after all payroll deductions. You can spend it on your wants, needs, savings, investments, or black tax.

For entrepreneurs, it is the amount of money left after you've paid your legally mandated contributions and taxes.

How to calculate your disposable income in Nigeria

To find your disposable income, deduct all your mandatory deductions from your gross income.

How to calculate your disposable income in Nigeria

A simple formula is:

Disposable income = Gross income – Total mandatory deductions

Say your gross monthly income is ₦300,000, your tax is ₦40,000, and your pension contribution is ₦20,000. The money left after these deductions (net pay) is ₦240,000. This is how much disposable income you have monthly.

Why is understanding disposable income important?

Understanding disposable income is crucial for effective financial management and planning. It lets you know the funds available for both essential and non-essential spending. Understanding disposable income is a vital step towards improving your financial well-being.

Why is understanding disposable income important?

Disposable income is a key indicator of how healthy your finances are. It tells you how much money you truly have to spend or save. On a larger scale, economists also use it to gauge the overall health of the

economy. If people have more disposable income, they're more likely to spend, which boosts economic activity. Some other reasons why it is essential to understand your disposable income are as follows:

Standard of living: More disposable income gives you access to the finer things. You can treat yourself every now and then, get quality accommodation, pursue hobbies and passion projects, and travel—do more of what gives you joy. The higher your take-home pay, the more comfortably you can live.

Financial freedom: Having some disposable income gives you the freedom to choose. A higher net income relieves financial stress, takes you out of survival mode and allows you to make plans. You can take care of today's needs while also setting money aside for future goals.

Saving and investing: More disposable income means you can create a bigger financial safety net for yourself by saving for emergencies or future goals like retirement.

Economic growth: Believe it or not, when you spend, you bolster the economy. Consumer spending is one of the biggest drivers of economic growth. Supporting local businesses helps create jobs, so the more you spend on products and services, the better the country's macroeconomic outlook.

See also [Lead Talks: Bukola Willoby Talks Customer Success & Its Role In Building A Strong Brand](#)

[How to manage disposable income: A guide to budgeting, spending and saving smart in Nigeria](#)

Your disposable income is yours to do as you please. And you'll probably spend most of it on essentials and other living expenses. However, in economic times marked by skyrocketing inflation, unstable fx rates, and unbearable living costs, learning how to manage your disposable income is an absolute game-changer.

[How to manage disposable income: A guide to budgeting, spending and saving smart in Nigeria](#)

Here are 11 smart and intentional ways to use your disposable income:

1. Emergency savings:

Life is full of surprises, some not so pleasant. Having an emergency fund gives you peace of mind, whether it's unexpected medical bills, a job loss, or urgent repairs.

Aim to save at least 3–6 months' living expenses in an accessible savings account like Piggyvest's Flex Naira. You also earn up to 12% interest annually on your savings. Your interest is paid monthly, provided there are no more than four withdrawals in that month.

[Flex Naira 2/25](#)

2. Goal-oriented savings:

With your disposable income, you can set and plan for specific financial goals. These could include a new car, laptop, school fees, or that trip you've been dreaming about. With our Target Savings, you can set goals and a savings timeline and save automatically. You can also create Group Targets to make regular contributions alongside your family or friends. All this while earning sweet interest.

[Target 2/25](#)

3. Budgeting:

A solid budget helps you control your spending and manage your disposable income properly. One simple budgeting method you can try is the 50/30/20 rule: allocate 50% to needs, 30% to wants, and 20% to savings.

See also [Side Bar: Generating Your Own Extra Income](#)

If, realistically, your needs require more than 50% of your income, that's no problem. You can easily tweak this method to suit your needs. What matters is that you stick to it.

4. Investment and asset management:

Don't just save, grow your money. Investing helps you beat inflation and build wealth over time. Start small with low-risk options, such as mutual funds, treasury bills, or Piggyvest's pre-vetted opportunities. Explore Piggyvest's Investify feature to access low-risk investment options that suit your risk appetite and budget.

[Investify 2/25](#)

5. Personal development:

Consider using part of your disposable income to upgrade your skills. Online courses, certifications, workshops, or even books can open up better job opportunities or help you launch a side hustle. Start with platforms like Coursera, Udemy, Treford, AltSchool or other local training programs that align with your career path.

6. Lifestyle improvement:

It's okay to chop life too! A once-in-a-blue-moon brunch, a better apartment, a gym membership, better gadgets and appliances, can make daily life more comfortable and productive. Lifestyle improvements are ideal, as long as they are within your means.

7. Planning for retirement:

Yesterday was the best time to start thinking about retirement, but today is also a great day to begin. Want to retire early? Then start making small but consistent contributions to a Retirement Savings Account (RSA).

8. Investing in your health:

Good health is your greatest asset. Use your disposable income to eat better, go for regular checkups, join a gym or fitness class, and buy health insurance if you can afford it. Prevention is better—and often cheaper—than curing illnesses.

See also [How Piggyvest Keeps Your Money Safe \(An Inside Look At How The Piggyvest Cybersecurity Team Protects Your Money\)](#)

9. Passion projects:

Disposable income can help you pursue your passions. If you have a love for fashion, photography, writing, or baking, you can allow a portion of your income to pursue these passions. Over time, this could become a side hustle or even your primary source of income. You never know.

10. Aiding family and friends:

Are you really Nigerian if you don't feel the obligation to support your family financially? Helping your loved ones is great, but ensure you plan it out first. Set aside a specific monthly amount to support your loved ones, and try not to exceed it. You can be generous without sabotaging your finances.

11. Side businesses:

Nigeria's economy makes it risky to rely on just one source of income. Use part of your disposable income to test or grow a side business—whether selling items online, running a logistics service, or offering your services as a freelancer online. Remember to start small, track your profits, and reinvest wisely.

Blog 2

Many people don't know it, but financial discipline is the secret to building wealth, reducing stress and gaining control over your money. And it's not some strange mystery! All you need is a set of habits and choices that empower you to make informed decisions about your finances — paving the way for a more secure and prosperous future.

You can develop financial discipline by understanding where you stand financially, setting SMART goals and creating a realistic budget. Then, you'll need to build a healthy saving habit, monitor your expenses, practice debt management, and seek professional advice.

In this guide, we'll simplify financial discipline by exploring 8 actionable steps you can follow to stop wasting money and show how PiggyVest can be a valuable partner in your journey to total money mastery. Ready to be financially disciplined? Let's jump right in!

1. Understand where you stand financially

How to develop financial discipline — Understand where you stand financially

The first step to financial discipline is knowing where you stand. No, we don't mean where you live or where you are right now — although that does matter. You need to know all you can about your money — where it's coming from, where it's going and just how much you're worth.

You can do this by first tracking your income from all sources (from salaries to side hustles) and then categorising your expenses (everything from rent to “enjoyment funds”). Doing this will give you a comprehensive picture of what's coming in and what's going out.

You can record this information in your notes app, on a piece of paper or use a spreadsheet!

The next step is to calculate your net worth by subtracting your total liabilities (debts) from your total assets (savings, investments, property). This gives a rough (but mostly accurate) snapshot of your financial health.

You can use these numbers as a baseline for setting realistic goals.

2. Set SMART money goals

How to develop financial discipline — Set SMART money goals

A money goal provides a north star for your finances — something you can work towards. But to be financially disciplined, this goal must be SMART.

You can set a SMART money goal by making it:

Specific. Don't be vague, use actionable goals. For example, "I want to save for a new iPhone" is more effective than saying, "I want to save more money."

Measurable. Track your progress towards your goal with concrete numbers. So, saying, "I want to save ₦1,000,000 for a new iPhone" is better since including the actual cost of the phone makes the goal measurable.

Achievable. Set goals that are realistic and attainable based on your income and expenses. For example, it might not be practical to say you want to save for a ₦1,000,000 iPhone if you earn ₦70,000 per month (unless you have zero expenses — trust fund kid!).

Relevant. Choose goals that align with your values and priorities. An iPhone might be a priority if you're a food content creator like Daniel Ochuko and it might be an unnecessary expense if you're a student trying to save money.

Time-bound. Set a deadline to create a sense of urgency and motivation. It's much better to say, "I want to get an iPhone at the end of the year" since the timeframe allows you to set a plan.

See also [4 PiggyVest Features That Will Help You Control Your Holiday Spending](#)

Therefore, a great (and SMART) goal will be you saying, "I want to save ₦1,000,000 for a new iPhone before the end of the year" if you need a new device and earn ₦1,100,000 monthly with a total expense of ₦300,000.

You can use the SMART framework for any financial goal — whether you want to save your first million, rent a new apartment or build an emergency fund.

3. Develop a realistic budget and personalise it

How to develop financial discipline — Develop a realistic budget and personalise it

Now that you have a goal (or multiple goals), it's time to create a budget. A budget is your financial roadmap, and It helps you allocate your income efficiently. With one, you can plan for and cover your needs, wants and savings goals.

We recommend you explore our article on budget creation if you need help making one that's amazing, but remember to make it realistic and tailor it to your needs.

If you're unsure of where how to start categorising your money, use the 50/30/20 rule by setting aside 50% of your income for your needs, 30% for your wants and 20% for your savings.

Of course, you can also try other budgeting methods — like envelope budgeting.

This technique involves allocating specific amounts of money to categories for different expenses. It helps promote disciplined spending by focusing on and limiting expenses within each category.

With an envelope budget, you could break down, say, your monthly transport expenses into weekly “chunks” to prevent overspending and use the Safelock feature on PiggyVest to control your access to the “extra funds” (while earning up to 17% returns annually).

4. Save money — make it a habit

How to develop financial discipline — Save money — make it a habit

The easiest way to save is to make it automatic. Fortunately, the PiggyVest app has all you need to make saving a habit. We recommend you start with Piggybank and use Autosave to automatically put money aside as often as possible.

Piggybank is great for financial discipline because you only get four free withdrawal days in a year — so you’re less likely to spend money for the fun of it. Plus, with up to 14% annual interest on your funds, you get paid for being in control — an extra win for your finances.

See also [10 Simple Ways Nigerians Can Manage Financial Stress](#)

You can set up monthly savings on Piggybank if you get paid monthly or use save daily if that works for you — it all depends on your money goals. Just pay yourself first before spending on needs and wants.

This approach ensures consistent savings, even when you’re tempted to spend. It also removes the temptation entirely since your excess cash will be far away from impulses and unplanned enjoyment.

5. Monitor your expenses and curtail your impulses

How to develop financial discipline — Monitor your expenses and curtail your impulses

Impulse spending can sabotage your financial progress — even if you budget every kobo of your income. Fortunately, you can stay in control by tracking and curtailing expenses.

You can easily track your daily expenses if you’re a PocketApp user by checking your transaction history on the home tab or generating your account statement in-app. Alternatively, you can use budgeting apps or spreadsheets.

With this information, you can identify spending patterns and areas where you can cut back.

But let’s be honest: cutting back is rarely the problem — impulse spending is. From random wraps of shawarma to unplanned shopping sprees, your budget can take a serious hit.

But there’s a way to keep things in check! When tempted by an impulse purchase, ask yourself if it aligns with your financial goals and if you truly need it. If that doesn’t work, use PiggyVest!

Piggybank also allows you to save money manually — anytime you want — and you can save some or all of the money you're tempted to spend. That way, you can curtail your impulses and enjoy a sweet 14% annual interest on your funds while you're at it.

6. Be ruthless with debt management

How to develop financial discipline — Be ruthless with debt management

Besides being an efficient planner, an obsessive saver and a smart spender, you also need to master debt management to be financially disciplined. An excellent way to do this is to avoid debt completely, but this isn't always feasible. After all, there are certain situations where taking debt might be unavoidable or even better for your finances.

Still, the trick is to stay away from dangerous debt that can derail your life.

You also want to avoid high-interest debt — like the ones from sketchy loan apps. These kinds of debt can be a major obstacle to financial freedom and they can pull you into a financial hole you may never escape from.

See also [Mastering Your Finances As A Creator: 7 Essential Tips From Our Latest Ebook](#)

For debt repayment, we already discussed some helpful tips in our article on debt management. We recommend reading it to know exactly how you can work towards being debt-free in Nigeria — regardless of the amount involved.

7. Seek professional advice

How to develop financial discipline — Seek professional advice

Now, this might seem a little random, but a solid piece of advice can do you much good when it comes to financial discipline. However, we recommend you only seek money advice from real professionals — like financial planners and tax consultants.

These experts are more than qualified to help you if you're struggling and they can even offer tailor-made recommendations that will help transform your finances for good. Still, we recommend that you consider seeking advice for specific situations like retirement planning or estate planning.

For example, you could reach out to Odunayo Eweniyi — COO and co-founder of PiggyTech — and ask financial questions via the Ask Odun column on our Money Matters newsletter.

8. Review and adjust your financial habits regularly

How to develop financial discipline — Review and adjust your financial habits regularly

While the seven strategies we've shared so far are a great place to start, the truth is that your financial situation and goals will evolve. Needless to say, this means that your approach to building and maintaining discipline must improve as well.

Therefore, we recommend that you regularly review your goals, examine your budget and track your spending habits to ensure they align with your current needs and aspirations.

Don't hesitate to make adjustments as necessary to stay on track!

The bottom line

Making bank is important, but having self-control with money is one of the most important skills you need to be financially stable — regardless of your income. The good news is that you can learn financial discipline and you don't have to starve or abandon the good life to stay disciplined.

The tips we've shared in this article are perfect for everyone — whether you're just developing discipline.

Blog 3

Trying to pay off your debt can seem overwhelming, but there are strategies that can help. Typically, the first step to paying off debt is to figure out exactly what you owe. There are generally two different approaches to take to help pay down your debt, and each method has its pros and cons. There is no right or wrong answer when it comes to which method is best because every person's debt situation differs. Sometimes it might even be a combination of both methods. It is up to you to determine what motivates you and which process may be the best fit for your situation.

What to know about the snowball vs. the avalanche method

The "snowball method," simply put, means paying off the smallest of all your loans as quickly as possible. Once that debt is paid, you take the money you were putting toward that payment and roll it onto the next-smallest debt owed. Ideally, this process would continue until all accounts are paid off. As you roll the money used from the smallest balance to the next on your list, the amount "snowballs" and gets larger and larger and the rate of the debt that is reduced is accelerated.

In contrast, the "avalanche method" focuses on paying the loan with the highest interest rate loans first. Similar to the "snowball method," when the higher-interest debt is paid off, you put that money toward the account with the next highest interest rate and so on, until you are done. By focusing on the loans that are the most expensive to carry in the long run, you should pay less over time as the higher interest loans are addressed first.

You may save some money with the "avalanche method," but if the principal is large, the time it may take to pay off debt with the highest interest can be discouraging and make it difficult to stick to the plan. Paying off small debts quickly can feel rewarding. If you prefer to see progress quickly and work your way up, then the "snowball method" may be a better fit for your debt management goals.

Perfecting your debt paydown strategy

Build an emergency fund: Have a safety net in place before you begin a debt paydown method. While it's good to want to become debt-free, having funds to rely on in case of situations like an unexpected medical bill or car repair should be a priority.

Stay up-to-date on all of your current bills: Don't start either the avalanche or the snowball method if you are late on payments, as this will only complicate your debt situation.

Track your spending: Be careful to not charge up additional debts while you are working to pay down your debt. Track your spending to ensure you stick to your budget.

Blog 4

So onto the deciding question, What exactly is Financial Literacy and why is it so important

Financial literacy is the education and understanding of knowing how money is made, spent, and saved as well as the skills and ability to use financial resources to make decisions. These decisions include how to generate, invest, spend, and save money.

Teaching basic financial literacy will help youths to reduce debt, increase savings, and give many individuals the tools to begin their journey of financial independence. Understanding financial jargon is like learning a new language. If you do not practice and use it, you'll lose it so in these series, we're taking a twist and giving people relatable advice that can help them on this journey so take a seat, relax and let's dive in

The first part in these Series will be Budgeting

Some people will probably be wondering why I'm beginning this series with Budgeting well it's quite simple; unless you know where your money is going at all times it's quite hard to monitor your cash flow, therefore, saving without intimate knowledge of one's expenses is not a good way for one to start out their journey to financial freedom

Budgeting is the act of setting up a plan for spending money based on a persons allowance/income and expenses or budgeting is simply telling your money where to go instead of wondering where it went

"Did you know: income is money earned while expense is money spent "

Budgeting allows you to create a spending plan for your money which basically ensures that you will always have enough money for the things you need or in other words, it helps you prioritize your needs and wants. Also answering the question "Why do I need this budget" helps a lot. You might want to save more money or you're simply tired of living hand to mouth or you may even want to desperately get out of debt, whatever your story is, A budget is a roadmap for where your money will go so you can make your allowance/income work for you.

The ideal way to budget is the 50/30/20 rule which expects you to spend 50% of your income on needs, 30% goes to wants and the other 20% goes to savings but I'm not writing this for ideal people because we as Nigerians are very unique individuals whose lives have no predictable pattern and therefore the 50/30/20 rule will do nothing but drive you crazy 😊(speaking from experience)

Anyways at this point in our lives, the recent pandemic has forced everyone to do a hard reset with their finances and that's probably why you're here. As students or perhaps recent graduates, your parents are no longer responsible for every single financial decision regarding your life and no one prepared us for that but no worries, you're in safe hands

Before you can create a realistic budget, you need to know what your current spending habits are. If your budget isn't realistic, it's nothing more than a wishlist.

The easiest way I've discovered that works almost seamlessly is to first of all list out all your sure sources of income (excluding money not included); I say this because drawing up a budget on funds that aren't sure is just messy and disillusioned which is far from reality

Secondly, outline the basic expenses that you need to take care of eg NEPA(PHICN)bill, Airtime & Data, entertainment/subscription, Data, foodstuffs, toiletries, transportation etc and then the One-time payments that occur either quarterly or annually (I assign 15% of my income/allowance to miscellaneous but this figure can be different for you)

Then outline your personalized financial goals because anyone who is setting up a budget has an important "why" and you can align the budget with the goals

Now that you are clear on your cash flow, it's much easier to decide how much to put aside as savings and perhaps investments. Ensure you try and stick with the budget for at least 3 months.

PS: it's okay to adjust your budget as your financial situation changes

Making a budget is only the first step now you have to figure out how to live by your budget. Some people are disciplined enough to just do it (I wasn't) but seeing as this is something new, give yourself room to fail and grow, it took me nearly 2 years to build up the discipline to stick to a budget so don't be too hard on yourself but strive to be accountable to yourself

Last but not least, review your budget periodically

Blog 5

I'm sure a lot of people will be wondering how exactly does spending habits play a part on the journey to financial freedom and I'd have to respond with this "there's no point in showing a man treasure if he has no self-discipline"

I'm sure there's no perfect person when it comes to spending habits and that's simply for the fact that we're human but we need to do better if we want to be financially free

So what exactly is a "spending habit"

Well, spending habits are an acquired behavioural pattern that is followed so regularly it's almost involuntary. Please note the word involuntary which means done without conscious control and those two words are very important because spending everything you earn without any sense of control is a money disorder or even waiting last minute to make payments and ignoring deals; all these things arise as a result of our spending habits.

Since it is a habit, there are good and bad sides to it and we're hoping to help anyone interested in financial freedom learn to let go of the negatives and embrace the good spending habits

Why are spending habits important

“Segun is a 25 year old Senior software engineer who's working for one of the top tech companies in Nigeria, his take-home is just over ₦300,000 monthly, he loves eating out, buying every latest gadget that comes out, always at the cinema and his rent is over ₦1.5 million annually because he loves his comfort, he didn't grow up with wealthy parents so he has an insatiable urge to spend money however he likes when he makes it ”

From the short narrative above, Segun is smart no doubt for him to be working in a top company but he's not money smart and no matter how hard he works, his money just keeps burning holes in his pocket. Unfortunately, it's not your salary that makes you rich, it's your spending habits and if they are not properly controlled it could lead to debt

Where you spend your money matters, Spending habits are important because when you see where most of your expenses are, it shows you what your priorities are unconsciously and most times it's not aligning with what your actual priorities are which means there's cognitive dissonance (when thoughts don't match one's actions)

The sad part is a lot of us weren't raised with proper spending habits, heck I'm sure half of us grew up with barely enough money to spend so it's no shock that a lot of people are bad with their spending but if you're reading this you know that something's not working and you want a change. So what exactly are the bad spending habits that are burning holes in our pockets, if any of these resonates with you, you're not alone

Failing to budget 😊

Impulse buying

Emotional spending (when under stress or pressure)

Purchasing of brand name items

Spending more than one earns

Buying the cheapest products to save money but it ends up costing you more

Not negotiating for a better deal

Going shopping without a list

Pulling off a Keeping Up With the Joneses (spending more than you can afford to impress people)

I can go on and on with the list but I'm sure a few already struck the right chord, we all know we need help and I could do the traditional thing and list out 3 guaranteed ways to improve your spending but we're Nigerians and I do not want to follow the way people supposedly spend from our nation, we're already in deep enough, so I'd just say this, everything starts in the mind and as cliché as it sounds it's the most effective thing

Nigeria in the 70s

Had one of the strongest currencies in the world with 75 Kobo = £1 & 60 Kobo = US\$1

Constant power supply

Excess jobs

Finland called Nigeria "a future world power."

Gowon said "Nigeria's only problem was how to spend money."

“A man who lets money dictate his life is simply being used by it when money is just a tool and we are the masters”

But if you think spending habits aren't all that important, check out these statistics which suggest that inasmuch as Nigeria had all the resources at its disposal to be great, failure to control its spending is why we are where we are because of lack of something so fundamental as appropriate allocation of funds.

The keyword here is self-control and I could go on and on mentioning how by rights we're free to do anything but is everything really beneficial. Though I strongly believe that this is a journey each of us has to go on for ourselves because I can't make anyone do anything, I'm just a guide

To break bad spending habits, consider how they make you feel. Most spending feels fun in the moment. It's in the minutes — or even months — afterwards that buyer's remorse sets in. Take a moment to jot down the last not-so-great choice you made with your money. Note how you felt when you made the decision, how you felt in the minutes and days after, and how you feel right now. You might notice a downward trajectory. This is what we want to work to change. Good spending habits might be a tough call at first, but they produce a lifetime of rewards!

You start by first deciding which spending habit you want to break, it's easier to start small and build-up to the really bad ones e.g going over on phone data subscription, eating out when you have food at home, shopping impulsively online.

Now the best way to work on your bad habits is by trying to replace it with a good one because by putting good spending habits in place, you'll eventually make smart money choices without much thought or effort.

Also spending wisely makes more sense when you have a target to it so if you're saving up for that phone or those shoes you've always wanted, keeping it in mind will help when you want to swipe that card plus learning to live on a budget might seem boring but it's a prudent move if becoming financially free is what you desire and monitoring your spending also helps you stick to your budget

This might sound weird but for me taking time each day to be grateful for the things we have that money cannot buy let's me appreciate all the things around me and that sense of appreciation inadvertently might just reduce your chances of just spending anyhow.

This one should be an obvious sell but please, learn and avoid your spending triggers or at least try and limit your contact with them until you know your willpower is strong enough to overcome the temptations.

Spending should be fun so instead of pretending that spending money is a bad thing, be intentional about setting aside a chunk of money — big or small — each month. That way you can browse your favourite store, enjoy a meal at your favourite restaurant, buy a new gadget, or take advantage of a great deal on Amazon without any guilt. Give yourself permission to spend some money and you won't be tempted to spend all the money.

Knowing that this is a lifetime journey, mastering self-control with respect to spending isn't going to just happen overnight, it's a daily routine we need to incorporate in our lives so don't be too hard on yourselves but strive to master control, it's a lifetime decision and even I still have bad habits I'm working on as well

Blog 6

I'm sure a lot of people will be wondering exactly what role Saving plays on the journey to financial freedom and I'd have to respond with "The art is not in making money, but in keeping it" though making money is an important skill which I'd delve into later in this series but learning how to keep it is a whole other ball game

Why exactly is Saving important?

The future is unpredictable and as funny as it sounds, just knowing that you're prepared for any unforeseen emergency is very reassuring and gives peace of mind

Now I know a lot of us will probably be thinking but I barely have enough money to get me through today, talkless of tomorrow and I understand because I've been there but we are in uncertain times and basically

If you wish to get rich, save what you get. A fool can earn money; but it takes a wise man to save and dispose of it to his own advantage

Want to know exactly why I like the concept of Savings

I'd tell you a secret, once you're more financially secure, it completely boosts your confidence and eases a lot of stress triggers because you know if you need to quickly sort out something worth let's say ₦10k, you don't have to run around, panic or make choices under unnecessary duress which is a win-win, I'm not saying go out looking for trouble or be someone like me who initially gave up essential things like health just to have savings and later paid the dear price for that silly decision which is all in the past but it taught me only the living can enjoy their money

Emergency funds

What are they and why are they so important???

Emergency funds create a financial buffer that can keep you afloat in times of need without having to take out high-interest loans or get in debt. The adequate amount one should have saved up is about 6 months of expenses

So how exactly do you save money then

It's a very simple principle and it's gotten from the book "Richest Man in Babylon" one of my best reads this year "pay yourself first." that means you should put away 10% of every money you receive into a savings account, now this savings can be allocated to an emergency fund amounting to at least 6 months coverage for basic essential expenses and Unforeseen events which are unpredictable and undesirable but need to be planned for.

Putting away some money may be difficult at first depending on your spending habits but we've already covered that in the last part of this series

The why is pretty self-explanatory, if you think that you can get away by giving yourself excuses that you're barely breaking even at the end of the month, you'd just be narrating that same excuse for the rest of your life but once you pay yourself first and you know you need to pay for the drinking water you need daily, it forces you to come up with a way to meet that expense while building your asset column

Also by breaking some bad spending habits, channel all those funds right back into savings. I know it sounds funny but living frugally is a sure guarantee that you'd be saving money, Frugal people cut back on most things, so they can feel good spending on a few things that are important to them while also saving for their big goals in the future.

So what apps or software help us save

Well there is probably one new app popping up every day for savings and what not but what I feel is needed is a high-interest savings app with easy access and unbeatable levels of security because what's the point of saving if I don't feel the savings itself is safe

I have all my savings in one place, and I've been with them for more than 7 years now and they've never given me any reason to doubt their services. I use Piggyvest to build up my emergency fund as well as regular savings

I know savings isn't easy and just like spending habits, it forces you to become more self-aware as a person, sacrifice overindulgence and not give in to every whim we feel but doing this will be a big step on the journey to financial freedom and I hope you understand it's okay to make mistakes, just learn from them and move on

I can't count how many times I touched my savings when I first started saving but now I hardly ever let myself go to that place, I now find more creative ways to take care of my needs.

Blog 7

“Buy now, pay later or pay small small” has become increasingly popular in recent years. This type of financing allows consumers to purchase items and pay for them over time, without having to pay interest or fees.

There are a number of advantages to using Pay Later. For one, it can help you spread the cost of a large purchase over time. Additionally, it can help you build your credit score since you are making regular payments on your purchase.

However, there are also a few disadvantages to using this type of financing. For one, you may be charged interest or fees if you miss a payment. Additionally, you may be required to put down a deposit on your purchase.

Before you decide to use this type of financing, it’s important to weigh the pros and cons. Keep reading to learn more about the 10 reasons to use buy now pay later financing!

Buy now pay later is a financial service that allows consumers to make purchases and defer payment for a set period of time. There are a number of reasons why you might want to use this service, including the following:

Pros of Using Buy Now Pay Later

1. You can take advantage of sales and discounts.
2. You can avoid interest charges.
3. You can free up cash flow.
4. You can improve your credit score.
5. You can rebuild your credit history.
6. You can pay off your debt faster.
7. You can consolidate your debts.
8. You can avoid late fees.
9. You can have more flexible payment options.
10. You can get products and services now and pay for them later.

CD Care empowers Africans to own easily using smart installments.

We grew up in the average Nigerian family where it took painfully saving for a period of time before simple house-hold appliances could be acquired. One of us waited for months for his mother to save for his first laptop and also realized that many Nigerian families also go through the same arduous circle.

He realized that this is a big problem that he wanted to solve. After iterating different solutions to the problem over 10 years, CDcare was founded as the best solution to the Africans inability to easily pay in one lump-sum for items. CDcare is the smartest way to buy in Africa today and we are happy to give Africans the power to own.